Security Council. So far, China is the only major power that has not endorsed India's membership.

How should India as an aspiring Great Power deal with China? One way is broadly the Nehruvian: India rising to become a full-fledged Great Power, by stealth, nuancing its rise, cultivating the image of a different kind of ascending power – a bridging or shaping power. This is the image of an India that looks after its interests, to be sure, but also leads coalitions of weaker states to create a more secure and emancipated world. India's External Affairs Minister Jaishankar in his recent book, *The India Way*, captures the orientation: 'The India Way, especially now, would be more of a shaper or decider than just be an abstainer . . . India must be a just and fair power as well, consolidating its position as a standard bearer of the global South . . . [it must] express its brand with growing confidence, whether in its civilizational attributes or in its contemporary achievements.'[96] Bharat Karnad, who has written two big books on India's Great Power ambitions, has a more traditional answer to what India must do: declare a 'Monroe Doctrine' in the ocean space around it; organize a coalition of rimland and offshore states surrounding China; access US capabilities in Asia; draw India's neighbours on the Asian landmass into its economic sphere; and 'build up versatile, strategically-oriented conventional military forces able to take the fight to China'.[97] The current chief of the RSS, Mohan Bhagwat, has the bluntest and simplest answer. India must beat China: 'In our military and economic preparations, in forging relations, internationally and with our neighbours, we will need to be bigger than China'.[98]

Chinese Worldviews and India

We can distinguish between three broad Chinese worldviews as well. The first is what might be labelled the *tianxia* ('all under heaven') view, the second is the republican and communist view, and the third is the Great Power view. The tianxia view draws on ancient Chinese philosophy, the republican and communist view is about a hundred years old, and the Great